

Robin Connor Schramm

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Research Profile

My research in Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) focuses on designing, building, and empirically evaluating interactive systems that enable meaningful interactions with emerging technologies. I develop functional prototypes and investigate them in carefully designed, realistic scenarios that reflect the contexts in which they are intended to be used. My current work brings these perspectives together to explore Human-AI interaction across multimodal and mixed-reality settings, integrating system design, empirical evaluation, and computational methods to understand and improve how people experience AI in different forms and contexts.

Research and Professional Experience

Human-Computer Interaction Group, University of Konstanz

Postdoctoral Researcher

Jun. 2026 – present

Konstanz, Germany

My research investigates Human-AI interaction in mixed reality, with a focus on how deeply AI systems engage with personal information and contexts, and how this shapes their benefits, risks, and acceptance. I also explore computational representations of AI manifestations and their perception, providing a foundation for systematic evaluation and data-driven optimization.

University College London (UCL)

Visiting Researcher

Mar. 2026 – May 2026

Host: [Dr. Mark Colley](#)

Supported by the German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) [HAW.International](#) program.

Mercedes-Benz Tech Innovation, XReality

Software Engineer

Oct. 2021 – May 2026

Böblingen, Germany

I designed and evaluated Unity-based in-car AR systems through laboratory and real-world vehicle studies while working with rapidly evolving hardware requirements. The resulting work included peer-reviewed HCI publications, one of which received a CHI 2025 Honorable Mention, as well as interactive demonstrations for research and industry audiences.

Fraunhofer IPA

Research Assistant

Feb. 2021 – Sep. 2021

Stuttgart, Germany

I built a Unity-based virtual-twin simulation for visual SLAM, enabling mobile-robot algorithms to be evaluated under dynamic and repeatable environmental conditions.

Reutlingen Research Institute

Research Assistant

Mar. 2020 – Feb. 2021

Reutlingen, Germany

Within [Project KI Delta Learning](#), I developed photogrammetry-based Unity simulations and applied computer vision techniques to generate synthetic data for autonomous-driving research.

Fraunhofer IAO

Research Assistant

Aug. 2019 – Feb. 2020

Stuttgart, Germany

I built collaborative Virtual Reality tools for visualizing and analyzing construction data.

Education

RheinMain University & Mercedes-Benz Tech Innovation

PhD in Human-Computer Interaction

Dec. 2022 – present

Advisor: [Prof. Dr. Ulrich Schwanecke](#)

Thesis Title: Interactive Points of Interest for In-Car Augmented Reality

Expected Defense: October 2026

Reutlingen University
Master of Science in Human-Centered Computing
Thesis Title: Simulation of Long-Term SLAM for Mobile Robots
Thesis Cooperation: [Fraunhofer IPA](#)

Sep. 2019 – Sep. 2021

Reutlingen University
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Media
Thesis Title: Comparison of Motion Tracking and Inverse Kinematics for Presence in Virtual Reality
Thesis Cooperation: [Fraunhofer IAO](#)

Mar. 2016 – Aug. 2019

Awards and Funding

- **CHI Honorable Mention Award for Best Paper** (top 5%), CHI 2025, for “[Augmented Journeys: Interactive Points of Interest for In-Car Augmented Reality](#)”
- **DAAD HAW.International funding** for a research stay at University College London (2026)

Selected Publications

1. **Robin Connor Schramm**, Ginevra Fedrizzi, Markus Sasalovici, Jann Philipp Freiwald, and Ulrich Schwanecke. 2025. *Augmented Journeys: Interactive Points of Interest for In-Car Augmented Reality*. In CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25), ACM, DOI: [10.1145/3706598.3714323](#)
🏆 Received a **CHI Honorable Mention Award for Best Paper** (top 5%)
2. **Robin Connor Schramm**, Markus Sasalovici, Jann Philipp Freiwald, Michael Otto, Melissa Reinelt, and Ulrich Schwanecke. 2025. *Blending the Worlds: World-Fixed Visual Appearances in Automotive Augmented Reality*. In CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25), ACM, DOI: [10.1145/3706598.3713185](#)
3. Markus Sasalovici, Albin Zeqiri, **Robin Connor Schramm**, Oscar Javier Ariza Nunez, Pascal Jansen, Jann Philipp Freiwald, Mark Colley, Christian Winkler, and Enrico Rukzio. 2025. *Bumpy Ride? Understanding the Effects of External Forces on Spatial Interactions in Moving Vehicles*. In CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25), ACM, DOI: [10.1145/3706598.3714077](#)
4. **Robin Connor Schramm**, Markus Sasalovici, Axel Hildebrand, and Ulrich Schwanecke. 2023. *Assessing Augmented Reality Selection Techniques for Passengers in Moving Vehicles: A Real-World User Study*. In ACM International Conference on Automotive User Interfaces and Interactive Vehicular Applications (AutomotiveUI '23), ACM, DOI: [10.1145/3580585.3607152](#)
5. Markus Sasalovici, Stephan Leenders, **Robin Connor Schramm**, Jann Philipp Freiwald, Hannes Frederic Botzet, Daniel Keßelheim, Thomas Krach, and Christian Winkler. 2023. *In-Car Office: Can HMD-Based AR Alleviate Passenger Motion Sickness?* In 15th International Conference on Automotive User Interfaces and Interactive Vehicular Applications (AutomotiveUI '23 Adjunct), ACM, DOI: [10.1145/3581961.3609869](#)

Teaching and Supervision

Lecturer, Scientific Writing
Reutlingen University

Oct. 2023 – Jul. 2026
Reutlingen, Germany

As lecturer for “Topics in Computer Science,” I taught scientific methods, literature reviews, academic writing, research presentations, and the responsible use of AI tools. Across six semesters, I reviewed and graded papers and presentations for more than 150 students.

Tutor, Basics in Programming
Reutlingen University

Mar. 2019 – Feb. 2021
Reutlingen, Germany

Led the Programming Fundamentals Lab, teaching C and Python through live coding and guided exercises; reviewed exam questions and supported grading.

Thesis Supervision

Master's theses as primary supervisor (all at Mercedes-Benz Tech Innovation):

- Leo Kruse, University of Porto (2025)
- Alireza Parchami, Saarland University (2025)
- Hongcheng Jia, University of Stuttgart (2024)
- Ginevra Fedrizzi, University of Trento (2024)

Academic Service

- Associate Chair for the [NordiCHI'26](#) Late-Breaking Work track
- Associate Chair for the [MuC'26](#) Full Papers track
- Proceedings Chair and Organizing Committee member for [MUM'26](#)
- Reviewer for CHI, MobileHCI, AutomotiveUI, ACM ISS, and the International Journal of Human-Computer Studies
- Student Volunteer at IEEE VR '21

Selected Talks and Demonstrations

- “Simulation and Using Unity as HCI Researchers.” Future Interfaces Lecture, University College London (UCL), 2026
- “Interactive Points of Interest for In-Car Augmented Reality.” Invited research talk, University of Konstanz, 2026
- “In-Car Mixed Reality: Current Research and Challenges.” Invited talk, Automotive User Interfaces Lecture, Ulm University, 2025
- “Success Story: Research in Automotive User Interfaces.” Company town hall, Mercedes-Benz Tech Innovation, 2025
- Mercedes-Benz PhD poster session, [Doktoranden Marktplatz](#), 2024
- “In-Car Augmented Reality with the Varjo XR-3.” Interactive live demonstration at the [Mercedes-Benz booth](#), WeAreDevelopers World Congress, 2023
- “Automotive User Interfaces in HCI.” Reutlingen University, 2023
- “Augmented Reality Selection Techniques in Moving Vehicles.” Research cluster talk, Mercedes-Benz AG, 2023
- “Integration of Head-Mounted Displays (HMDs) in Cars.” Tech talk, Mercedes-Benz Tech Motion, 2022

Technical and Research Skills

- **Development:** Unity and C# for interactive XR prototyping on Windows and Android; Python, C, and Java; Git and GitHub
- **Data and Analysis:** R for statistical analysis and data visualization; qualitative and quantitative data analysis
- **Research Methods:** Experimental design; laboratory and field studies; mixed-methods evaluation; systematic literature reviews; academic writing and peer review
- **Research Domains:** Human-AI interaction; mixed and augmented reality; automotive HCI; interactive simulation
- **AI-Assisted Software Engineering:** Code generation, refactoring, debugging, and technical documentation, with systematic validation of generated outputs
- **Languages:** German (native); English (proficient)